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SMART HOME DEVICE USING A SINGLE RADAR TRANSMISSION MODE FOR ACTIVITY RECOGNITION OF ACTIVE USERS AND VITAL SIGN MONITORING OF INACTIVE USERS

Abstract

Various arrangements for monitoring for contactless human interactions and health using a single radar transmission modulation mode are provided. Radar chirps may be output by a radar sensor operating in a burst mode. The burst mode radar data stream may be monitored for a contactless human interaction performed by an active user. The burst mode radar data stream may be converted to a virtual continuous mode radar data stream. Health monitoring of an inactive user may be performed using the virtual continuous mode radar data stream.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCES TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/026,875, filed March 17, 2023, entitled “Smart Home Device Using a Single Radar Transmission Mode For Activity Recognition of Active Users and Vital Sign Monitoring of Inactive Users,” which is a 371 National Stage filing of PCT App. No. PCT/US2020/051776, filed Sep. 21, 2020, entitled “Smart Home Device Using a Single Radar Transmission Mode For Activity Recognition of Active Users and Vital Sign Monitoring of Inactive Users”, the entire disclosure of these applications is hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes. This application is related to the following applications: PCT Application PCT/US2019/031290, filed May 8, 2019, entitled “Sleep Tracking and Vital Sign Monitoring Using Low Power Radio Waves;” U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/990,714, filed Aug. 11, 2020, entitled “Contactless Sleep Detection and Disturbance Attribution for Multiple Users;” U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/990,705, filed Aug. 11, 2020, entitled “Contactless Sleep Detection and Disturbance Attribution; U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/990,720, filed Aug. 11, 2020, entitled “Contactless Cough Detection and Attribution; U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/990,726, filed Aug. 11, 2020, entitled “Precision Sleep Tracking Using a Contactless Sleep Tracking Device;” U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/990,746, filed Aug. 11, 2020, entitled “Initializing Sleep Tracking on a Contactless Health Tracking Device;” and PCT Application PCT/US2020/048388, filed Aug. 28, 2020, entitled “Precision Sleep Tracking Using a Contactless Sleep Tracking Device.” The entire disclosures of these applications are hereby incorporated by reference for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

[0002] It can be convenient for a user to interact with a device without making any physical contact with the device (or another input device). For instance, hand gestures may be performed and detected by a device and interpreted as a command. While such contactless interactions are useful, the ability of the device to perform other tasks without contact may also be desired. Such other tasks may have competing requirements that need to be balanced with detection of contactless interactions.

SUMMARY

[0003] Various embodiments are described related to a contactless health monitoring device. In some embodiments, a contactless health monitoring device is described. The device may comprise a housing. The device may comprise a radar sensor, housed by the housing, configured to operate in a burst mode in which the radar sensor emits a plurality of bursts of radar chirps. A first amount of time elapsing between multiple radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps may be smaller than a second amount of time elapsing between subsequent bursts of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps. The radar sensor outputs a burst mode radar data stream that may be based on reflections of the radar chirps of the plurality of bursts or radar chirps. The device may comprise a processing system, housed by the housing, comprising one or more processors, that may be in communication with the radar sensor. The processing system may be configured to receive the

burst mode radar data stream from the radar sensor. The processing system may be configured to analyze the burst mode radar data stream to identify a contactless human interaction. The processing system may be configured to convert the burst mode radar data stream to a virtual continuous mode radar data stream. The processing system may be configured to perform health monitoring of a user using the virtual continuous mode radar data stream.

[0004] Embodiments of such a device may include one or more of the following features: the virtual continuous mode radar data stream may be comprised of a plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time. The processing system being configured to convert the burst mode radar data stream to the virtual continuous mode radar data stream may comprise the processing system being configured to create a virtual reflection of a radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts. The virtual reflection of the radar chirp may be part of the plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time. The processing system being configured to create the virtual reflection of the radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of the burst of the plurality of bursts may comprise the processing system being configured to perform an averaging process. The processing system may comprise sampling a plurality of samples of each radar chirp of the multiple chirps of the burst. The processing system may comprise averaging each sample of the plurality of samples with corresponding samples from the other chirps of the multiple chirps of the burst to create a plurality of averaged samples. The processing system may comprise assembling the averaged samples to create the virtual reflection of the radar chirp. The contactless human interaction may be detected while health monitoring is being performed. The radar sensor may output frequency-modulated continuous wave (FMCW) radar. The contactless human interaction may be a gesture. The contactless human interaction may be presence detection. The health monitoring may comprise sleep monitoring of the user. The virtual continuous mode radar data stream may have higher resolution than the burst mode radar data stream due to dithering. The device may further comprise a wireless network interface housed by the housing. The device may further comprise an electronic display housed by the housing. The device may further comprise a microphone housed by the housing. The device may further comprise a speaker housed by the housing. The wireless network interface, the electronic display, the microphone, and the speaker may be in communication with the processing system. The processing system may be further configured to receive a spoken command via the microphone. The processing system may be further configured to transmit an indication of the spoken command via the wireless network interface to a cloud-based server system. The processing system may be further configured to receive a response from the cloud-based server system via the wireless network interface. The processing system may be further configured to output information obtained from the performed health monitoring via the electronic display, the speaker, or both based on the response from the cloud-based server system. The processing system may be further configured to output a report based on the health monitoring.

[0005] In some embodiments, a method for monitoring for contactless human interactions and monitoring health using a single radar modulation mode is described. The method may comprise emitting radar chirps, by a radar sensor operating in a burst mode, such that the radar sensor emits a plurality of bursts of radar chirps. A first amount of time elapsing between subsequent radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps may be smaller than a second amount of time elapsing between subsequent bursts of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps. The radar sensor outputs a burst mode radar data stream that may be based on reflections of the radar chirps of the plurality of bursts or radar chirps. The method may comprise receiving, by a processing system, the burst mode radar data stream from the radar sensor. The method may comprise analyzing, by the processing system, the burst mode radar data stream for a contactless human interaction. The method may comprise converting, by the processing system, the burst mode radar data stream to a virtual continuous mode radar data stream. The method may comprise performing, by the processing system, health monitoring of a user using the virtual continuous mode radar data stream.

[0006] Embodiments of such a method may include one or more of the following features: the virtual continuous mode radar data stream may be comprised of a plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time. The processing system being configured to convert the burst mode radar data stream to the virtual continuous mode radar data stream may comprise the processing system being configured to create a virtual reflection of a radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts. The virtual reflection of the radar chirp may be part of the plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time. Creating the virtual reflection of the radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of the burst of the plurality of bursts may comprise sampling a plurality of samples of each radar chirp of the multiple chirps of the burst. Creating the virtual reflection of the radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of the burst of the plurality of bursts may comprise averaging each sample of the plurality of samples with corresponding samples from the other chirps of the multiple chirps of the burst to create a plurality of averaged samples. Creating the virtual reflection of the radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of the burst of the plurality of bursts may comprise assembling the averaged samples to create the virtual reflection of the radar chirp. The contactless human interaction may be a gesture. The contactless human interaction may be presence detection. The health monitoring may comprise sleep monitoring of the user.

[0007] Various arrangements of smart home devices are present in some embodiments. A smart home device can include a housing that is configured for placement of the smart home device in areas of user activity, user sleep, or both. A smart home device can include a radar sensor, housed by the housing, configured to operate in a burst mode in which the radar sensor transmits a plurality of bursts of radar chirps, receives reflections of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps, and outputs a single radar data stream based on the reflections of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps. A first amount of time can elapse between adjacent radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps is smaller than a second amount of time elapsing between adjacent bursts of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps. A smart home device can include a processing system, housed by the housing, comprising one or more processors, that is in communication with the radar sensor. The processing system can be configured to perform a first set of operations on the single radar data stream to perform user activity recognition. The processing system can be configured to perform a second set of operations on the single radar data stream to perform user vital sign detection, wherein no radar transmission mode changes are required to perform both the user activity recognition and the user vital sign detection using the single radar data stream.

[0008] Embodiments of such smart home devices can include one or more of the following features: The second set of operations can include instructions to convert the single radar data stream to a virtual continuous mode radar data stream. The user activity recognition can be gesture detection. The virtual continuous mode radar data stream can include a plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time. The instructions to convert the single radar data stream to the virtual continuous mode radar data stream can include instructions that cause the processing system to create a virtual reflection of a radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts, wherein the virtual reflection of the radar chirp is part of the plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time.

[0009] The processing system being configured to create the virtual reflection of the radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of the burst of the plurality of bursts can include the processing system being configured to perform an averaging process, comprising: sampling a plurality of samples of each radar chirp of the multiple chirps of the burst; averaging each sample of the plurality of samples with corresponding samples from the other chirps of the multiple chirps of the burst to create a plurality of averaged samples; and assembling the averaged samples to create the virtual reflection of the radar chirp. The user activity recognition can be performed while detection of the user vital sign is being performed. The radar sensor can output frequency-modulated

continuous wave (FMCW) radar having a frequency between 57-64 GHz and a peak EIRP of less than 20 dBm.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0010] A further understanding of the nature and advantages of various embodiments may be realized by reference to the following figures. In the appended figures, similar components or features may have the same reference label. Further, various components of the same type may be distinguished by following the reference label by a dash and a second label that distinguishes among the similar components. If only the first reference label is used in the specification, the description is applicable to any one of the similar components having the same first reference label irrespective of the second reference label.

[0011] FIG. 1 illustrates an embodiment of a system for performing contactless health and user interaction monitoring.

[0012] FIG. 2A illustrates an embodiment of a health tracking system that uses radar to detect human interactions and perform health monitoring.

[0013] FIG. 2B illustrates an embodiment of a health tracking system that uses radar to detect human interactions and perform health monitoring with integrated beam targeting.

[0014] FIG. 2C illustrates an embodiment of frequency-modulated continuous wave radar radio waves output by a radar subsystem.

[0015] FIG. 3A illustrates an embodiment of a contactless health tracking device.

[0016] FIG. 3B illustrates an exploded view of an embodiment of a contactless health tracking device.

[0017] FIG. 4 illustrates an embodiment of a state system for determining when a person is sleeping.

[0018] FIG. 5 illustrates a diagram of radar chirps being received in a burst mode.

[0019] FIG. 6 illustrates a diagram of radar chirps being received in a burst mode and converted to a virtual continuous mode.

[0020] FIG. 7 illustrates an embodiment of a method for monitoring for contactless human interactions and monitoring health using a single radar modulation mode.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0021] Embodiments detailed herein are focused on a device performing contactless health monitoring, such as contactless sleep monitoring, while also monitoring for contactless human interactions. Contactless health monitoring can involve tracking a user's sleep (of an inactive user), monitoring a user's vital signs, tracking a user's coughs, etc. Contactless health monitoring may be performed using radar. A contactless human interaction can be a gesture (e.g., a user moving his hand or arm in a particular way that is to be interpreted as a command) or presence (e.g., a user being detected as present within a vicinity of the device) as performed by an active user. A device may monitor for contactless human interactions using radar.

[0022] Since both contactless health monitoring and contactless human interaction monitoring can use radar, competing demands can be present between the two types of monitoring. For example, contactless health monitoring may be performed effectively when the radar sensor is operated in a continuous mode. In a continuous mode, a radar chirp may be received periodically. However, for human interaction monitoring to be performed effectively, the radar sensor may be operated in a burst mode. In burst mode, a series of radar chirps (a "burst") are emitted, then a period of time is waited before starting a next burst of radar chirps. The period of time waited between bursts may be to limit the total amount of energy emitted into an environment of the user, thereby decreasing the user's exposure to RF energy.

[0023] In embodiments detailed herein, a radar sensor may be operated in burst mode. Therefore, the radar data stream output by the radar sensor may be optimized for human interaction monitoring. Processing may be performed on the radar data stream to create a virtual continuous mode radar data stream. This virtual continuous mode radar data stream can be created such that the virtual continuous mode radar data stream comprises higher-quality data than if the radar sensor itself operated in continuous mode.

[0024] By creating a virtual continuous mode radar data stream, a single device or system that receives the radar data stream can effectively monitor for human interactions in burst mode and perform health monitoring in a continuous mode. Therefore, a single device may be able to effectively respond to a contactless human interaction while health monitoring is being performed without a user having to switch a mode of the device or system. Similarly, the device or system can continuously operate the radar sensor in burst mode without having to change the mode in which the radar sensor operates. Rather, the device or system continuously creates a virtual continuous mode radar data stream, thereby allowing monitoring for contactless user interactions and contactless health monitoring to occur simultaneously and independent of each other.

[0025] Further detail regarding such embodiments and additional embodiments can be understood in relation to the figures. FIG. 1 illustrates an embodiment of a system **100** for performing contactless health and user interaction monitoring. System **100** can include: contactless health and human interaction monitoring device **101** (“device **101**”); network **160**; and cloud-based server system **170**. Device **101** can include: processing system **110**; sleep data storage **118**; radar subsystem **120**; environmental sensor suite **130**; electronic display **140**; wireless network interface **150**; and speaker **155**. Generally, device **101** can include a housing that houses all of the components of device **101**. Further detail regarding such a possible housing is provided in relation to FIG. 3A and FIG. 3B. Device **101** can also be referred to as a health monitoring device, a health tracking device, a sleep monitoring device, a sleep tracking device, or a home assistant device.

[0026] Processing system **110** can include one or more processors configured to perform various functions, such as the functions of: radar processing module **112**; sleep state detection engine **114**; and environmental event correlation engine **116**. Processing system **110** can include one or more special-purpose or general-purpose processors. Such special-purpose processors may include processors that are specifically designed to perform the functions detailed herein. Such special-purpose processors may be ASICs or FPGAs which are general-purpose components that are physically and electrically configured to perform the functions detailed herein. Such general-purpose processors may execute special-purpose software that is stored using one or more non-transitory processor-readable mediums, such as random access memory (RAM), flash memory, a hard disk drive (HDD), or a solid state drive (SSD).

[0027] Radar subsystem **120** (also referred to as a radar sensor), can be a single integrated circuit (IC) that emits, receives, and outputs a radar data stream indicative of received reflected radio waves. The output of radar subsystem **120** may be analyzed using radar processing module **112** of processing system **110**. Further detail regarding radar subsystem **120** and radar processing module **112** is provided in relation to FIG. 2.

[0028] Device **101** may include one or more environmental sensors, such as all, one, or some combination of the environmental sensors provided as part of environmental sensor suite **130**. Environmental sensor suite **130** can include: light sensor **132**; microphone **134**; temperature sensor **136**; and passive infrared (PIR) sensor **138**. In some embodiments, multiple instances of some or all of these sensors may be present. For instance, in some embodiments, multiple microphones may be present. Light sensor **132** may be used for measuring an ambient amount of light present in the general environment of device **101**.

[0029] Microphone **134** may be used for measuring an ambient noise level present in the general environment of device **101**. Temperature sensor **136** may be used for measuring an ambient temperature of the general environment of device **101**. PIR sensor **138** may be used to detect

moving living objects (e.g., persons, pets) within the general environment of device **101**. Other types of environmental sensors are possible. For instance, a camera and/or humidity sensor may be incorporated as part of environmental sensor suite **130**. In some embodiments, some data, such as humidity data, may be obtained from a nearby weather station that has data available via the Internet.

[0030] Device **101** may include various interfaces. Display **140** can allow processing system **110** to present information for viewing by one or more users. Wireless network interface **150** can allow for communication using a wireless local area network (WLAN), such as a WiFi-based network. Speaker **155** can allow for sound, such as synthesized speech, to be output. For instance, responses to spoken commands received via microphone **134** may be output via speaker **155** and/or display **140**. The spoken commands may be analyzed locally by device **101** or may be transmitted via wireless network interface **150** to cloud-based server system **170** for analysis. A response, based on the analysis of the spoken command, can be sent back to device **101** via wireless network interface **150** for output via speaker **155** and/or display **140**. Additionally or alternatively, the speaker **155** and microphone **134** may be collectively configured for active acoustic sensing, including ultrasonic acoustic sensing. Additionally or alternatively, other forms of wireless communication may be possible, such as using a low-power wireless mesh network radio and protocol (e.g., Thread) to communicate with various smart home devices. In some embodiments, a wired network interface, such as an Ethernet connection, may be used for communication with a network. Further, the evolution of wireless communication to fifth generation (5G) and sixth generation (6G) standards and technologies provides greater throughput with lower latency which enhances mobile broadband services. 5G and 6G technologies also provide new classes of services, over control and data channels, for vehicular networking (V2X), fixed wireless broadband, and the Internet of Things (IoT).

[0031] Such standards and technologies may be used for communication by device **101**.

[0032] The low-power wireless mesh network radio and protocol may be used for communicating with power limited devices. A power-limited device may be an exclusively battery powered device. Such devices may rely exclusively on one or more batteries for power and therefore, the amount of power used for communications may be kept low in order to decrease the frequency at which the one or more batteries need to be replaced. In some embodiments, a power-limited device may have the ability to communicate via a relatively high power network (e.g., WiFi) and the low-power mesh network. The power-limited device may infrequently use the relatively high power network to conserve power. Examples of such power-limited devices include environmental sensors (e.g., temperature sensors, carbon monoxide sensors, smoke sensors, motion sensors, presence detectors) and other forms of remote sensors.

[0033] Wireless network interface **150** can allow for wireless communication with network **160**. Network **160** can include one or more public and/or private networks. Network **160** can include a local wired or wireless network that is private, such as a home WLAN. Network **160** may also include a public network, such as the Internet. Network **160** can allow for device **101** to communicate with remotely-located cloud-based server system **170**.

[0034] Cloud-based server system **170** can provide device **101** with various services. Regarding sleep data, cloud-based server system **170** can include processing and storage services for sleep-related data. While the embodiment of FIG. 1 involves processing system **110** performing sleep state detection and environmental event correlation, in other embodiments, such functions may be performed by cloud-based server system **170**. Also, in addition or in alternate to sleep data storage **118** being used to store sleep data, sleep-related data may be stored by cloud-based server system **170**, such as mapped to a common user account to which device **101** is linked. If multiple users are monitored, the sleep data may be stored and mapped to a master user account or to the corresponding users' accounts.

[0035] Cloud-based server system **170** may additionally or alternatively provide other cloud-based

services. For instance, device **101** may additionally function as a home assistant device. A home assistant device may respond to vocal queries from a user. In response to detecting a vocal trigger phrase being spoken via microphone **134**, device **101** may record audio. A stream of the audio may be transmitted to cloud-based server system **170** for analysis. Cloud-based server system **170** may perform a speech recognition process, use a natural language processing engine to understand the query from the user, and provide a response to be output by device **101** as synthesized speech, an output to be presented on electronic display **140**, and/or a command to be executed by device **101** (e.g., raise the volume of device **101**) or sent to some other smart home device. Further, queries or commands may be submitted to cloud-based server system **170** via electronic display **140**, which may be a touchscreen. For instance, device **101** may be used to control various smart home devices or home automation devices. Such commands may be sent directly by device **101** to the device to be controlled or may be sent via cloud-based server system **170**.

[0036] Based on data output by radar processing module **112**, sleep state detection engine **114** may be used to determine whether a user is likely asleep or awake. Sleep state detection engine **114** may progress through a state machine, such as detailed in relation to FIG. **4** or may use the state identified using such a state machine to determine whether the user is likely awake or asleep. For example, if a user is determined to be in bed and still for at least a defined period of time, the user may be identified as asleep. The output of sleep state detection engine **114** may be used by environmental event correlation engine **116**. Environmental event correlation engine **116** may analyze data received from environmental sensor suite **130**. Data from each environmental sensor device may be monitored for: 1) an increase of the environmental condition above a fixed defined threshold; and/or 2) an increase in the environmental condition by at least a predefined amount or percentage. As an example, data indicating the light level in the ambient environment may be continuously or periodically output by light sensor **132**. Environmental event correlation engine **116** may determine whether: 1) the ambient amount of lighting has increased from below a fixed defined threshold to above the fixed defined threshold; and/or 2) the ambient amount of lighting has increased by at least a predefined amount of percentage. If options 1, 2, or both occur, it may be determined that an environmental event has occurred. This environmental event may be timestamped by environmental event correlation engine **116**. Environmental event correlation engine **116** may then determine whether the user waking can be attributed to the identified environmental event.

[0037] The radar data stream output by radar subsystem **120** may be output to human interaction engine **245** in addition to radar processing module **112**. Human interaction engine **245** may use the radar data stream to determine if a human interaction, such as a human moving within a defined distance of device **101** or a gesture has been performed. Further detail regarding how radar subsystem **120**, radar processing module **112**, and human interaction engine **245** function and interact is detailed in relation to FIGS. **2A** and **2B**.

[0038] FIG. **2A** illustrates an embodiment of a health monitoring system **200A** ("system **200A**") that uses radar to detect human interactions and perform health monitoring. System **200A** can include radar subsystem **205** (which can represent an embodiment of radar subsystem **120**); radar processing module **210** (which can represent an embodiment of radar processing module **112**); beam steering module **230**; virtual continuous chirp creator **240**; and human interaction engine **245**.

[0039] Radar subsystem **205** may include RF emitter **206**, RF receiver **207**, and radar processing circuit **208**. RF emitter **206** can emit radio waves, such as in the form of continuous-wave (CW) radar. RF emitter **206** may use frequency-modulated continuous-wave (FMCW) radar. The FMCW radar may operate in a continuous sparse-sampling mode over a relatively long period of time. RF emitter **206** may include one or more antennas and may transmit at or about 60 GHz. The frequency of radio waves transmitted may repeatedly sweep from a low to high frequency (or the reverse). The power level used for transmission may be very low such that radar subsystem **205** has

an effective range of several meters or an even shorter distance. Further detail regarding the radio waves generated and emitted by radar subsystem **205** are provided in relation to FIG. **2C**.

[0040] RF receiver **207** includes one or more antennas, distinct from the transmit antenna(s), and may receive radio wave reflections off of nearby objects of radio waves emitted by RF emitter **206**. The reflected radio waves may be interpreted by radar processing circuit **208** by mixing the radio waves being transmitted with the reflected received radio waves, thereby producing a mixed signal that can be analyzed for distance. Based on this mixed signal, radar processing circuit **208** may output raw waveform data, which can also be referred to as a raw chirp waterfall for analysis by a separate processing entity. Radar subsystem **205** may be implemented as a single integrated circuit (IC) or radar processing circuit **208** may be a separate component from RF emitter **206** and RF receiver **207**. In some embodiments, radar subsystem **205** is integrated as part of device **101** such that RF emitter **206** and RF receiver **207** are pointing in a same direction as display **140**. In other embodiments, an external device that includes radar subsystem **205** may be connected with device **101** via wired or wireless communication. For example, radar subsystem **205** may be an add-on device to a home assistant device.

[0041] RF subsystem **205** outputs a radar data stream. Since RF subsystem **205** is operated in burst mode, the radar data stream output may be referred to as a burst mode radar data stream. The burst mode radar data stream may be output by radar subsystem **205** to human interaction engine **245** and to virtual continuous chirp creator **240**. Human interaction engine **245** and virtual continuous chirp creator **240** may be implemented as software that is executed using the same processing system as radar processing module **210**. In other embodiments, a separate processing system may be used for virtual continuous chirp creator **240**, human interaction engine **245**, or both. In other embodiments, dedicated hardware may be used to perform the functions of virtual continuous chirp creator **240**, human interaction engine **245**, or both.

[0042] Human interaction engine **245** may use the burst mode radar data stream to determine if any human interaction has occurred. The processing performed by human interaction engine **245** may occur independently of the processing performed by virtual continuous chirp creator **240** and radar processing module **210**. Therefore, whether or not health monitoring is being performed by radar processing module **210** or a component that uses data output by radar processing module **210** may be irrelevant to human interaction engine **245** monitoring for contactless human interactions, such as presence and gestures. To be clear, “contactless” refers to there being no physical contact between a user and the device on which system **200A** is implemented. Rather, remote sensing, such as radar, is used to monitor the user.

[0043] Virtual continuous chirp creator **240** also receives the burst mode radar data stream. Virtual continuous chirp creator **240** performs processing on the received burst mode radar data stream and outputs a virtual continuous mode radar data stream. Specifics on the processing performed by virtual continuous chirp creator **240** to create the virtual continuous mode radar data stream is provided in relation to FIG. **6**. The output of virtual continuous chirp creator **240** is provided to radar processing module **210**. Radar processing module **210** performs processing on the virtual continuous mode radar data stream the same as if a continuous mode radar data stream was output to radar processing module **210** directly by radar subsystem **205**.

[0044] For radar subsystem **205**, if FMCW is used, an unambiguous FMCW range can be defined. Within this range, a distance to objects can be accurately determined. However, outside of this range, a detected object could be incorrectly interpreted as nearer than an object within the unambiguous range. This incorrect interpretation can be due to the frequency of the mixed signal and the sampling rate of the ADC used by the radar subsystem to convert the received analog signals to digital signals. If the frequency of the mixed signal is above the Nyquist rate of the sampling of the ADC, the digital data output by the ADC representative of the reflected radar signal can be incorrectly represented (e.g., as a lower frequency indicative of a closer object).

[0045] Radar processing module **210** may include one or more processors. Radar processing

module **210** may include one or more special-purpose or general-purpose processors. Special-purpose processors may include processors that are specifically designed to perform the functions detailed herein. Such special-purpose processors may be ASICs or FPGAs which are general-purpose components that are physically and electrically configured to perform the functions detailed herein. General-purpose processors may execute special-purpose software that is stored using one or more non-transitory processor-readable mediums, such as random access memory (RAM), flash memory, a hard disk drive (HDD), or a solid state drive (SSD). Radar processing module **210** may include: movement filter **211**; frequency emphasize **212**; range-vitals transform engine **213**; range gating filter **214**; spectral summation engine **215**; and neural network **216**. Each of the components of radar processing module **210** may be implemented using software, firmware, or as specialized hardware.

[0046] The virtual continuous mode radar data stream from virtual continuous chirp creator **240** may be received by radar processing module **210** and first processed using movement filter **211**. In some embodiments, it is important that movement filter **211** is the initial component used to perform filtering. That is, the processing performed by radar processing module **210** is not commutative in some embodiments. Typically, vital sign determination and sleep monitoring may occur when a monitored user is sleeping or attempting to sleep in a bed. In such an environment, there may typically be little movement. Such movement may be attributed to the user moving within the bed (e.g., rolling over while trying to get to sleep or while asleep) and the user's vital signs, including movement due to breathing and movement due to the monitored user's heartbeat. In such an environment, a large portion of emitted radio waves from RF emitter **206** may be reflected by static objects in the vicinity of the monitored user, such as a mattress, box spring, bed frame, walls, furniture, bedding, etc. Therefore, a large portion of the raw waveform data received from radar subsystem **205** may be unrelated to user movements and the user's vital measurements.

[0047] Movement filter **211** may include a waveform buffer that buffers “chirps” or slices of received raw waveform data. For instance, sampling may occur at a rate of 10 Hz. In other embodiments, sampling may be slower or faster. Movement filter **211** may buffer twenty seconds of received raw waveform chirps in certain embodiments. In other embodiments, a shorter or longer duration of buffered raw waveform data is buffered. This buffered raw waveform data can be filtered to remove raw waveform data indicative of stationary objects. That is, for objects that are moving, such as a monitored user's chest, the user's heartbeat and breathing rate will affect the distance and velocity measurements made by radar subsystem **205** and output to movement filter **211**. This movement of the user will result in “jitter” in the received raw waveform data over the buffered time period. More specifically, jitter refers to the phase shifts caused by moving objects reflecting emitted radio waves. Rather than using the reflected FMCW radio waves to determine a velocity of the moving objects, the phase shift induced by the motion in the reflected radio waves can be used to measure vital statistics, including heart rate and breathing rate, as detailed herein.

[0048] For stationary objects, such as furniture, a zero phase shift (i.e., no jitter) will be present in the raw waveform data over the buffered time period. Movement filter **211** can subtract out such raw waveform data corresponding to stationary objects such that motion-indicative raw waveform data is passed to frequency emphasize **212** for further analysis. Raw waveform data corresponding to stationary objects may be discarded or otherwise ignored for the remainder of processing by radar processing module **210**.

[0049] In some embodiments, an infinite impulse response (IIR) filter is incorporated as part of movement filter **211**. Specifically, a single-pole IIR filter may be implemented to filter out raw waveform data that is not indicative of movement. Therefore, the single-pole IIR filter may be implemented as a high-pass, low-block filter that prevents raw waveform data indicative of movement below a particular frequency from passing through to frequency emphasize **212**. The cut-off frequency may be set based on known limits to human vital signs. For example, a breathing rate may be expected to be between 10 and 60 breaths per minute. Movement data indicative of a

lower frequency than 10 breaths per minute may be excluded by the filter. In some embodiments, a band-pass filter may be implemented to exclude raw waveform data indicative of movement at high frequencies that are impossible or improbable for human vital signs. For instance, a heartrate, which can be expected to be above a breathing rate, may be unlikely to be above 150 beats per minute for a person in a resting or near-resting state. Raw waveform data indicative of a higher frequency may be filtered out by the band pass filter.

[0050] In some embodiments, it may be possible to further fine-tune the frequencies of raw waveform data that movement filter **211** passes to frequency emphasize **212**. For instance during an initial configuration phase, a user may provide information about the monitored user (e.g., himself, a child), such as age data. Table 1 indicates typical respiratory rates for various ages. Similar data may be present for heartrate. The filter may be configured to exclude data that is outside of the expected breathing rate, heartrate range, or both.

TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Breathing Rate Range Age (breaths per minute) Birth-6 weeks 30-60
6 months 25-40 3 years 20-30 6 years 18-25 10 years 17-23 Adults 12-18 65-80 years old 12-28
>80 years old 10-30

[0051] The vital signs of the monitored user being measured are periodic impulse events: a user's heartrate may vary over time, but it can be expected that the user's heart will continue to beat periodically. This beating is not a sinusoidal function, but rather may be understood as an impulse event, more analogous to a square wave having a relatively low duty cycle that induces motion in the user's body. Similarly, a user's breathing rate may vary over time, but breathing is a periodic function performed by the user's body that is analogous to sinusoidal function, except that a user's exhale is typically longer than their inhale. Further, at any given time, a particular window of waveform data is being analyzed. Since a particular time window of waveform data is being analyzed, even a perfect sinusoid within that window can result in spectral leakage in the frequency domain. Frequency components due to this spectral leakage should be deemphasized.

[0052] Frequency emphasize **212** may work in conjunction with range-vitals transform engine **213** to determine the one (e.g., breathing) or two (e.g., breathing plus heartbeat) frequency components of the raw waveform data. Frequency emphasize **212** may use frequency windowing, such as a 2D Hamming window (other forms of windowing are possible, such as a Hann window), to emphasize important frequency components of the raw waveform data and to deemphasize or remove waveform data that is attributable to spectral leakage outside of the defined frequency window. Such frequency windowing may decrease the magnitude of raw waveform data that is likely due to processing artifacts. The use of frequency windowing can help reduce the effects of data-dependent processing artifacts while preserving data relevant for being able to separately determine heartrate and breathing rate.

[0053] For a stationary bedside FMCW radar-based monitoring device, which may be positioned within 1 to 2 meters of the one or more users being monitored to detect breathing and heartrate (e.g., using radar as emitted in FIG. 2C), a 2D Hamming window that emphasizes frequencies in the range of 10 to 60 bpm (0.16 Hz to 1 Hz) for breathing and 30 to 150 bpm (0.5 to 2.5 Hz) for heartbeat provide for sufficiently good signals to make reliable measurements without requiring advance knowledge of the subject's age or medical history.

[0054] Since heartrate and breathing rate are periodic impulse events, the frequency domain heartrate, and breathing rate may be represented by different fundamental frequencies, but each may have many harmonic components at higher frequencies. One of the primary purposes of frequency emphasize **212** may be to prevent the frequency ripples of harmonics of the monitored user's breathing rate from affecting the frequency measurement of the monitored user's heartrate (or the reverse). While frequency emphasize **212** may use a 2D Hamming window, it should be understood that other windowing functions or isolating functions can be used to help isolate frequency ripples of the monitored user's breathing rate from the frequency ripples of the monitored user's heartrate.

[0055] Range-vitals transform engine **213** analyzes the received motion-filtered waveform data to identify and quantify the magnitude of movement at specific frequencies. More particularly, range-vitals transform engine **213** analyzes phase jitter over time to detect relatively small movements due to a user's vital signs that have a relatively low frequency, such as breathing rate and heart rate. The analysis of range-vitals transform engine **213** may assume that the frequency components of the motion waveform data are sinusoidal. Further, the transform used by range-vitals transform engine **213** can also identify the distance at which the frequency is observed. Frequency, magnitude, and distance can all be determined at least in part because radar subsystem **205** uses an FMCW radar system.

[0056] Prior to applying the transform of range-vitals transform engine **213**, a zero-padding process may be performed by range-vitals transform engine **213** to add a number of zeros to the motion-filtered raw waveform data. By performing a zero-padding process, the resolution within the frequency domain can be increased effectively, allowing for more accurate low-rate measurements (e.g., a low heartrate, a low breathing rate). For example, zero-padding can help numerically increase resolution to detect differences of half a breath per minute compared to a resolution of a breath per minute without zero-padding. In some embodiments, three to four times the number of zeros compared to the buffered sample size of the raw waveform data may be added. For example, if twenty seconds of buffered raw waveform data are analyzed, sixty to eighty seconds' worth of zero padding may be added to the sample. Specifically, the range of three to four times zero padding of the sample was found to substantially increase resolution while not making the transform process overly complex (and, thus, processor use-intensive).

[0057] In order to determine the amount of zero padding to be performed, equations 1-3 may be used. In equation 1, RPM_resolution may ideally be less than 1.

$$[00001] \text{RPM}_{\text{resolution}} = 60 * \frac{\text{chirp_rate}}{\text{n_fft_slow_time}} \quad \text{Eq. 1}$$

$$\text{n_FFT_slow_time_min} = (\text{nearest_power_of_2})(60 * \text{chirp_rate}) \quad \text{Eq. 2}$$

[0058] In some embodiments, a chirp rate (chirp_rate) of 30 Hz may be used. Such a frequency may have sufficient margin from Nyquist limits of the upper limit of breathing rate and heartbeat rate. n_FFT_slow_time_min may, therefore, be 2048. Given a 20 second window for estimating respiration statistics, Equation 3 results in a value of 600.

$$[00002] \text{n_chirps_for_respiration} = 20 * \text{chirp_rate} = 600 \quad \text{Eq. 3}$$

[0059] This value of 600 is smaller than the required vitals-FFT size and makes range-vitals transform engine **213** perform a 3× to 4× zero padding. A balance in how much zero padding to perform may be based on increasing the frequency resolution and associated increases in the amount of computation needed to perform the FFT. A 3× to 4× zero padding has been found to provide sufficient resolution for heartrate and breath rate while moderating the amount of computation needing to be performed.

[0060] Range-vitals transform engine **213** can perform a series of Fourier transform (FT) to determine the frequency components of the received raw waveform data output by frequency emphasis engine **212**. Specifically, a series of fast Fourier transform (FFT) may be performed by range-vitals transform engine **213** to determine the specific frequencies and magnitudes of waveform data at such frequencies.

[0061] Waveform data obtained over a period of time can be expressed in multiple dimensions. A first dimension (e.g., along the y-axis) can relate to multiple samples of waveform data from a particular chirp and a second dimension (e.g., along the x-axis) relates to a particular sample index of waveform data gathered across multiple chirps. A third dimension of data (e.g., along the z-axis) is present indicative of the intensity of the waveform data.

[0062] Multiple FFTs may be performed based on the first and second dimension of the waveform data. FFTs may be performed along each of the first and second dimensions: an

[0063] FFT may be performed for each chirp and an FFT may be performed for each particular

sample index across multiple chirps that occurred during the period of time. An FFT performed on waveform data for a particular reflected chirp can indicate one or more frequencies, which, in FMCW radar, are indicative of the distances at which objects are present that reflected emitted radio waves. An FFT performed for a particular sample index across multiple chirps can measure the frequency of phase jitter across the multiple chirps. Therefore, the FFT of the first dimension can provide the distance at which a vital statistic is present and the FFT of the second dimension can provide a frequency of the vital statistic. The output of the FFTs performed across the two dimensions is indicative of: 1) the frequencies of vital statistics; 2) the ranges at which the vital statistics were measured; and 3) the magnitudes of the measured frequencies. In addition to values due to vital statistics being present in the data, noise may be present that is filtered, such as using spectral summation engine **215**. The noise may be partially due to heartrate and breathing not being perfect sinusoidal waves.

[0064] To be clear, the transform performed by range-vitals transform engine **213** differs from a range-Doppler transform. Rather than analyzing changes in velocity (as in a range-Doppler transform), periodic changes in phase shift over time are analyzed as part of the range-vitals transform. The range-vitals transform is tuned to identify small movements (e.g., breathing, heart rate) occurring over a relatively long period of time by tracking changes in phase, referred to as phase jitter. As previously detailed, zero padding is performed to allow for sufficient resolution for accurate determination of heartrate and breathing rate.

[0065] Range gating filter **214** is used to monitor a defined range of interest and exclude waveform data due to movement beyond the defined range of interest. For arrangements detailed herein, the defined range of interest may be 0 to 1 meter. In some embodiments, this defined range of interest may be different or possibly set by a user (e.g., via a training or setup process) or by a service provider. In some embodiments, a goal of this arrangement may be to monitor the one person closest to the device (and exclude or segregate data for any other person farther away, such as a person sleeping next to the person being monitored). In other embodiments, if both persons are to be monitored, the data may be segregated, as detailed in relation to FIG. **12**. Therefore, range-vitals transform engine **213** and range gating filter **214** serve to segregate, exclude, or remove movement data attributed to objects outside of the defined range of interest and sum the energy of movement data attributed to objects within the defined range of interest. The output of range gating filter **214** may include data that has a determined range within the permissible range of range gating filter **214**. The data may further have a frequency dimension and a magnitude. Therefore, the data may possess three dimensions.

[0066] Spectral summation engine **215** may receive the output from range gating filter **214**. Spectral summation engine **215** may function to transfer the measured energy of harmonic frequencies of the heartrate and breathing rate and sum the harmonic frequency energy onto the fundamental frequency's energy. This function can be referred to as a harmonic sum spectrum (HSS). Heartrate and breathing rate are not sinusoidal; therefore, in the frequency domain, harmonics will be present at frequencies higher than the fundamental frequency of the user's breathing rate and the fundamental frequency of the user's heartrate. One of the primary purposes of spectral summation engine **215** is to prevent harmonics of the monitored user's breathing rate from affecting the frequency measurement of the monitored user's heartrate (or the reverse). The HSS may be performed at the second order by summing the original spectrum with a down-sampled instance (by a factor of two) of the spectrum. This process may also be applied at higher order harmonics such that their respective spectra are added to the spectrum at the fundamental frequency.

[0067] At this stage, for a person in bed who is lying still (with the exception of movement due to breathing and heartrate), it will be expected that two major frequency peaks will present in the frequency data. However, if the monitored user is physically moving, such as rolling over in bed, the energy will be significantly distributed across the frequency spectrum (a broader distribution).

Such large physical movement may manifest itself in the frequency data as being a large number of small peaks. If the bed is empty, rather than a person being present, there may be no or almost no frequency components above the noise floor since movement filter **211** has previously filtered raw waveform data corresponding to static objects. The distribution and magnitude of frequency peaks across the spectrum may be used to determine if the user is likely awake or asleep.

[0068] Spectral summation engine **215** may output a feature vector that is indicative of heartrate (e.g., in beats per minute) and breathing rate (e.g., in breaths per minute). The feature vector can indicate frequency and magnitude. Neural network **216** may be used to determine whether the heartrate and/or breathing rate indicated in the output of the feature vector from spectral summation engine **215** should be considered valid. Therefore, the heartrate and breathing rate output by spectral summation engine **215** may be stored, presented to a user, and/or treated as valid based on the output of neural network **216**. Neural network **216** may be trained (e.g., using supervised learning performed using a training set of data) to output one of three states, such as those indicated in Table 2 by performing a spectral analysis. Vital statistic data may be considered valid when the user is determined to be present and the detected movement is due to the user's vital signs.

[0069] Each state in Table 2 is associated with a different spectral energy and spectral sparsity profile. Spectral energy refers to a summation of the energy across the frequency spectrum detected due to motion being present within the monitored region. Spectral sparsity represents whether movement tends to be distributed across a wide range of frequencies or clustered at a few specific frequencies. For instance, if energy peaks occur at few frequencies, such as when the user's vital signs are detected (but not other movement), spectral sparsity is high. However, if peaks (over a threshold value) or some other form of determination based on a threshold criterion at least partially based on magnitude) occur at many frequencies, spectral sparsity is low.

[0070] As an example, motion due to a vital sign, such as a heartbeat, may be indicative of significant movement (e.g., high spectral energy) at specific frequencies (e.g., high spectral sparsity); motion due to a user moving a limb may also be indicative of significant movement (high spectral energy), but may have low spectral sparsity. The neural network may be trained to distinguish between each state based on the spectral energy profile output by spectral summation engine **215**. Therefore, neural network **216** may be provided two features, a first value representing spectral energy and a second value representing spectral sparsity.

[0071] The output of spectral summation engine **215** may be characterized as a feature vector having a first dimension of frequency and a second dimension of amplitude. The first value representing spectral energy may be calculated by determining the maximum amplitude present in the feature vector output by spectral summation engine **215**. This maximum amplitude value may be normalized to a value within 0 to 1. The second value representing the spectral sparsity may be calculated by subtracting the median amplitude of the feature vector from the maximum amplitude. Again here, the calculated sparsity may be normalized to a value within 0 to 1.

[0072] Table 2 represents a generalization of how the features of spectral energy and spectral sparsity is used as features by the trained neural network to classify the state of the monitored region.

TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 State of Monitored Region Spectral Energy Spectral Sparsity User present and vitals-only High High movement User present and moving (limb High Low and torso movements) No user present Low Low

[0073] The state of the monitored region classified by neural network **216** may be used in determining the monitored user's sleep state or, more generally, whether the user is moving or still within bed. The state of the monitored region as determined by the performed classification of neural network **216** may further be used to determine if the vital statistics output by spectral summation engine **215** should be trusted or ignored. For accurate vital statistic determination, heartrate and breathing rate may be identified as likely accurate when neural network **216** determines that the user is present and still (i.e., no large physical movements; however, movement

is occurring due to breathing and/or heartbeat). In some embodiments, the vital statistics output by spectral summation engine **215** may be exclusively stored locally (e.g., to alleviate privacy concerns); in other embodiments, the vital statistics output may be transmitted to cloud-based server system **170** for remote storage (in alternative or in addition to such data being stored locally).

[0074] Neural network **216** may be initially trained using a large set of training data of amplitude and frequency feature vectors that have been properly tagged with a classification as mapping the spectral energy and the spectral sparsity to the corresponding ground-truth state of the monitored region. Alternatively, neural network **216** may be initially trained using a large set of training data of amplitude and frequency feature vectors that has been properly classified as mapping the comprising spectral energy and the spectral sparsity pairs each properly tagged to the corresponding ground-truth state of the monitored region. The neural network may be a fully connected neural network that is not time-dependent. In some embodiments, a machine-learning arrangement, classifier, or form of artificial intelligence other than a neural network may be used.

[0075] In other embodiments, rather than a spectral energy value and a spectral sparsity value being the features used by the neural network, a neural network, possibly with extra front-end convolutional layers, can be trained to use the output of range gating filter **214** directly. Rather, an embodiment of a convolutional network can analyze the frequency and magnitude data output by range gating filter **214** to classify the state of the user. The convolutional neural network may be trained to utilize offline training that is based on a set of spectral measurements mapped to the ground truth state of the monitored region prior to system **200B** being used by an end user.

[0076] The sleep state determined by neural network **216** may be stored, along with time data, to sleep data storage **118**. The vital statistics output by spectral summation engine **215** can be stored to a vital statistic datastore when neural network **216** indicates that the monitored user is present and still. Other vital statistic data may be discarded or possibly flagged to indicate it is less likely to be correct. The data stored to sleep data storage **118** and a vital statistic datastore may be stored locally at device **101**. In some embodiments, storage occurs at only device **101**. Such an implementation may help alleviate a concern about health-related data being transmitted and stored remotely. In some embodiments, the monitored user may elect to have sleep data and vital statistic data transmitted via a network interface (e.g., wireless network interface **150**), stored, and analyzed externally, such as by cloud-based server system **170**. Storage by cloud-based server system **170** may have significant benefits, such as the ability for the user to access such data remotely, allow access to a medical provider, or participate in research studies. The user may retain the ability to delete or otherwise remove the data from cloud-based server system **170** at any time.

[0077] In some embodiments, radar processing module **210** may be wholly or partly located remotely from device **101**. While radar subsystem **205** may need to be local to the monitored user, the processing of radar processing module **210** may be moved to cloud-based server system **170**. In other embodiments, a smart home device that is in local communication (e.g., via a LAN or WLAN) with device **101** may perform some or all of the processing of radar processing module **210**. In some embodiments, a local communication protocol, such as involving a mesh network, can be used to transmit the raw waveform data to the local device that will be performing the processing. Such communication protocols can include Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, Thread, or communication protocols of the IEEE 802.11 and 802.15.4 families. Similar to the processing, storage of the sleep data and vital statistic data may occur at cloud-based server system **170** or another smart home device in the home at which device **101** is located. In still other embodiments, radar processing module **210** may be incorporated with radar subsystem **205** as a single component or system of components.

[0078] The stored sleep data of sleep data storage **118** and the vital statistic data may be used to provide the user with short-term and long-term trends relating to their sleeping patterns, vital statistics, or both by sleep data compilation engine **119**. For instance, each morning, graphs,

statistics, and trends may be determined by sleep data compilation engine **119** based on data stored to sleep data storage **118** and output for display by sleep data compilation engine **119** via display **140**. A graph that is indicative of sleep data from the previous night and possibly one or more graphs indicative of breathing rates and heartrate during the previous night may be presented. Similar graphs, trends, and statistics may be output for significantly longer periods of time, such as weeks, months, years, and even multi-year stretches of time by sleep data compilation engine **119**. Other uses for sleep data and vital statistics may be possible. For instance, if certain triggers regarding heartrate, breathing rate, and/or sleeping patterns are triggered, a medical professional may be notified. Additionally or alternatively, a notification may be output to the user indicating that the collected data is potentially concerning or is indicative of a healthy person. In some instances, specific sleep problems may be identified, such as sleep apnea. Sleep data may be output via speaker **155** using synthesized speech (e.g., in response to the user waking, in response to a spoken user command, or in response to a user providing input via a touchscreen, such as display **140**). Such sleep data may also be represented graphically and or textually on display **140**.

[0079] System **200A** may additionally include beam steering module **230**. Beam steering module **230** may include channel weighting engine **231**, which may be implemented similarly to the components of radar processing module **210** using software, firmware, and/or hardware. Beam steering module **230** is illustrated as separate from radar processing module **210** because it processes data received from radar subsystem **205** to emphasize data received from a particular direction and deemphasize data received from other directions. Beam steering module **230** may be implemented using the same hardware as radar processing module **210**. For instance, beam steering module **230** may be a software process that modifies the radar data received from radar subsystem **205** prior to movement filter **211** being applied. Device **101** may be a surface-top device that is intended to be placed in a particular location, connected with a continuous power supply (e.g., a household power outlet) and interacted with via voice and/or a touchscreen. Therefore, radar subsystem **205** may remain pointed at a portion of the ambient environment for significant periods of time (e.g., multiple hours, days, weeks, months). Generally speaking, beam steering module **230** may be used to map the environment (e.g., room) in which device **101** is located and steer the sensing direction of radar subsystem **205** to a zone within the field-of-view of radar subsystem **205** most likely to have a user present.

[0080] Targeting the region within the field-of-view of radar subsystem **205** may help decrease an amount of false negatives and positives caused by movement of objects other than a user. Further, targeting can help compensate for an angle and location of device **101** relative to where the user sleeps. (For instance, device **101** may be located on a nightstand that is at a different height than the user's bed. Additionally or alternatively, radar subsystem **205** device **101** might not be pointed directly at the location in the bed where the user sleeps.)

[0081] When no user is determined to be present, such as based on low spectral energy and low spectral density of Table 2, an optimal beam steering process may be performed by channel weighting engine **231** and beam steering system **232**. While no user is present, an analysis can be performed to determine which directional alignment of radar subsystem **205** provides minimal-clutter.

[0082] FIG. 2B illustrates an embodiment of a health tracking system **200B** ("system **200B**") that uses radar to detect human interactions and perform health monitoring with integrated beam targeting. Beam targeting performed by using beam steering module **230** can focus on radar reflections from a region in which a user may be present and ignore or at least decrease the use of radar reflections from objects that cause interference, such as a nearby wall or large object. Notably, beam steering module **230** may perform processing on the virtual continuous mode radar data stream; therefore, the burst mode radar data stream analyzed by human interaction engine **245** can be unaffected by the targeting performed by beam steering module **230**.

[0083] Virtual continuous chirp creator **240** and human interaction engine **245** may function as

detailed in relation to FIG. 2A. However, the virtual continuous mode radar stream output by virtual continuous chirp creator **240** is input to beam steering module **230** instead of directly to radar processing module **210**. Radar subsystem **205** may output separate data for each antenna of radar subsystem **205**. Therefore, a separate burst mode radar data stream may be present for each antenna (or within a single burst mode radar data stream, the particular antenna that received the reflected radio waves may be indicated). Virtual continuous chirp creator **240** may maintain the separate of data for each antenna. Therefore, virtual continuous mode radar data streams may be created for each antenna or a single virtual continuous mode radar data stream may be created that indicates what portions of the virtual continuous mode radar data stream correspond to which antenna of radar subsystem **205**.

[0084] Radar subsystem **205** may contain multiple antennas to receive reflected radar radio waves. In some embodiments, three antennas may be present. These antennas may be aligned in an “L” pattern, such that two antennas are horizontally orthogonal and two antennas are vertically orthogonal with one of the antennas being used in both the horizontal arrangement and vertical arrangement. By analyzing the phase difference in received radar signals, a weighting may be applied to target the received radar beam vertically and/or horizontally. In other embodiments, the antennas may be aligned in a different pattern.

[0085] Vertical targeting may be performed to compensate for a vertical tilt of the device in which system **200B** is incorporated. For instance, as discussed below in relation to FIG. 3A, the face of contactless health tracking device **300** may be tilted with respect to where a user will typically be sleeping.

[0086] Horizontal targeting may be performed to compensate for emitted radar being pointed towards an object that causes interference. For instance, if a user's bed headboard is against a wall, the headboard and/or wall may occupy a significant portion of the field-of-view of radar subsystem **120**. Radar reflections from the headboard and/or wall might not be useful in determining data about the user; therefore, it may be beneficial to deemphasize reflections from the wall and/or headboard and emphasize reflections obtained away from the wall and/or headboard. Therefore, the receive beam may be steered horizontally away from the wall and the headboard by weighting applied to the received radar signals.

[0087] In system **200B**, beam steering module **230** is present to perform processing on the raw chirp waterfall of the virtual continuous mode radar data stream received from radar subsystem **205** via virtual continuous chirp creator **240**. Therefore, beam steering module **230** can function as a preprocessing module prior to the analysis of radar processing module **210** and can serve to emphasize regions where one or more users are expected to be present. Beam steering module **230** may be implemented using hardware, software, or firmware; therefore, beam steering module **230** may be implemented using the same one or more processors as radar processing module **210**.

[0088] Beam steering module **230** can include channel weighting engine **231** and beam steering system **232**. Channel weighting engine **231** can be used to perform a training process to determine a series of weightings to be applied to received radar signals from each antenna prior to the received radar signals being mixed together. Channel weighting engine **231** may perform a training process when a monitored region is determined to be empty. During such time, the strength of signals received from large static objects (e.g., walls, headboards) can be analyzed and weightings can be set to steer the beam horizontally (and possibly vertically) away from such objects.

Therefore, the amount of reflection in a static environment may be minimized for a particular distance range (e.g., up to one meter) from the device by channel weighting engine **231** steering the receive radar beam. Such training may also be performed when a user is present. That is, the receive beam of radar subsystem **205** can be steered to where motion is detected, or specifically, vital signs of a user are present.

[0089] The weightings determined by channel weighting engine **231** may be used by beam steering system **232** to individually apply a weight to the received reflected radar signals of each antenna.

The received signals from each antenna may be weighted then mixed together for processing by radar processing module **210**.

[0090] FIG. **2C** illustrates an embodiment of chirp timing diagram **200C** for frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) radar radio waves output by a radar subsystem. Chirp timing diagram **200C** is not to scale. Radar subsystem **205** may generally output radar in the pattern of chirp timing diagram **200C**. Chirp **250** represents a continuous pulse of radio waves that sweeps up in frequency from a low frequency to a high frequency. In other embodiments, individual chirps may continuously sweep down from a high frequency to a low frequency, from a low frequency to a high frequency, and back to a low frequency, or from a high frequency to a low frequency and back to a high frequency. In some embodiments, the low frequency is 58 GHz and the high frequency is 63.5 GHz. (For such frequencies, the radio waves may be referred to as millimeter waves.) In some embodiments, the frequencies are between 57 and 64 GHz. The low frequency and the high frequency may be varied by embodiment. For instance, the low frequency and the high frequency may be between 45 GHz and 80 GHz. The frequencies select may be selected at least in part to comply with governmental regulation. In some embodiments, each chirp includes a linear sweep from a low frequency to a high frequency (or the reverse). In other embodiments, an exponential or some other pattern may be used to sweep the frequency from low to high or high to low.

[0091] Chirp **250**, which can be representative of all chirps in chirp timing diagram **200C**, may have chirp duration **252** of 128 μ s. In other embodiments, chirp duration **252** may be longer or shorter, such as between 50 μ s and 1 ms. In some embodiments, a period of time may elapse before a subsequent chirp is emitted. Inter-chirp pause **256** may be 205.33 μ s. In other embodiments, inter-chirp pause **256** may be longer or shorter, such as between 10 μ s and 1 ms. In the illustrated embodiment, chirp period **254**, which includes chirp **250** and inter-chirp pause **256**, may be 333.33 μ s. This duration varies based on the selected chirp duration **252** and inter-chirp pause **256**.

[0092] A number of chirps that are output, separated by inter-chirp pauses may be referred to as frame **258** or frame **258**. Frame **258** may include twenty chirps. In other embodiments, the number of chirps in frame **258** may be greater or fewer, such as between 1 and 100. The number of chirps present within frame **258** may be determined based upon an average amount of power that is desired to be output within a given period of time. The FCC or other regulatory agency may set a maximum amount of power that is permissible to be radiated into an environment. For example, a duty cycle requirement may be present that limits the duty cycle to less than 10% for any 33 ms time period. In one particular example in which there are twenty chirps per frame, each chirp can have a duration of 128 μ s, and each frame being 33.33 ms in duration. The corresponding duty cycle is $(20 \text{ frames}) \cdot (0.128 \text{ ms}) / (33.33 \text{ ms})$, which is about 7.8%. By limiting the number of chirps within frame **258** prior to an inter-frame pause, the average output power may be limited. In some embodiments, the peak EIRP (effective isotropically radiated power) may be 13 dBm (20 mW) or less, such as 12.86 dBm (19.05 mW). In other embodiments, the peak EIRP is 15 dBm or less and the duty cycle is 15% or less. In some embodiments, the peak EIRP is 20 dBm or less. That is, at any given time, the average power radiated over a period of time by the radar subsystem might be limited to never exceed such values. Further, the total power radiated over a period of time may be limited. In some embodiments, a duty cycle may not be required.

[0093] Frames may be transmitted at a frequency of 30 Hz (33.33 ms) as shown by time period **260**. In other embodiments, the frequency may be higher or lower. The frame frequency may be dependent on the number of chirps within a frame and the duration of inter-frame pause **262**. For instance, the frequency may be between 1 Hz and 50 Hz. In some embodiments, chirps may be transmitted continuously, such that the radar subsystem outputs a continuous stream of chirps interspersed with inter-chirp pauses. Tradeoffs can be made to save on the average power consumed by the device due to transmitting chirps and processing received reflections of chirps. Inter-frame pause **262** represents a period of time when no chirps are output. In some embodiments, inter-frame pause **262** is significantly longer than the duration of frame **258**. For

example, frame **258** may be 6.66 ms in duration (with chirp period **254** being 333.33 μ s and 20 chirps per frame). If 33.33 ms occur between frames, inter-frame pause **262** may be 26.66 ms. In other embodiments, the duration of inter-frame pause **262** may be larger or smaller, such as between 15 ms and 40 ms.

[0094] In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 2C, a single frame **258** and the start of a subsequent frame are illustrated. It should be understood that each subsequent frame can be structured similarly to frame **258**. Further, the transmission mode of the radar subsystem may be fixed. That is, regardless of whether a user is present or not, the time of day, or other factors, chirps may be transmitted according to chirp timing diagram **200C**. Therefore, in some embodiments, the radar subsystem always operates in a single transmission mode, regardless of the state of the environment or the activity attempting to be monitored. A continuous train of frames similar to frame **258** may be transmitted while device **101** is powered on.

[0095] FIG. 3A illustrates an embodiment of a contactless sleep tracking device **300** (“device **300**”). Device **300** may have a front surface that includes a front transparent screen **340** such that a display is visible. Such a display may be a touchscreen. Surrounding front transparent screen **340** may be an optically-opaque region, referred to as bezel **330**, through which radar subsystem **205** may have a field-of-view of the environment in front of device **300**.

[0096] For purposes of the immediate following description, the terms vertical and horizontal describe directions relative to the bedroom in general, with vertical referring to a direction perpendicular to the floor and horizontal referring to a direction parallel to the floor. Since the radar subsystem, which may be an Infineon® BGT60 radar chip, is roughly planar and is installed generally parallel to bezel **330** for spatial compactness of the device as a whole, and since the antennas within the radar chip lie in the plane of the chip, then, without beam targeting, a receive beam of radar subsystem **120** may be pointed in direction **350** that is generally normal to bezel **330**. Due to a departure tilt of bezel **330** away from a purely vertical direction, which is provided in some embodiments to be about 25 degrees in order to facilitate easy user interaction with a touchscreen functionality of the transparent screen **340**, direction **350** may point upwards from horizontal by departure angle **351**. Assuming device **300** will typically be installed on a bedside platform (e.g., nightstand) that is roughly the same height as the top of a mattress on which a user will sleep, it may be beneficial for the receive beam of radar subsystem **120** to be targeted in horizontal direction **352** or an approximately horizontal (e.g., between -5° and 5° from horizontal) direction. Therefore, vertical beam targeting can be used to compensate for departure angle **351** of the portion of device **300** in which radar subsystem **120** is present.

[0097] FIG. 3B illustrates an exploded view of an embodiment of contactless sleep tracking device **300**. Device **300** can include: display assembly **301**; display housing **302**; main circuit board **303**; neck assembly **304**; speaker assembly **305**; base plate **306**; mesh network communication interface **307**; top daughterboard **308**; button assembly **309**; radar assembly **310**; microphone assembly **311**; rocker switch bracket **312**; rocker switch board **313**; rocker switch button **314**; Wi-Fi assembly **315**; power board **316**; and power bracket assembly **317**. Device **300** can represent an embodiment of how device **101** may be implemented.

[0098] Display assembly **301**, display housing **302**, neck assembly **304**, and base plate **306** may collectively form a housing that houses all of the remaining components of device **300**. Display assembly **301** may include an electronic display, which can be a touchscreen, that presents information to a user. Display assembly **301** may, therefore, include a display screen, which can include a metallic plate of the display that can serve as a grounding plane. Display assembly **301** may include transparent portions away from the metallic plate that allow various sensors a field of view in the general direction in which display assembly **301** is facing. Display assembly **301** may include an outer surface made of glass or transparent plastic that serves as part of the housing of device **300**.

[0099] Display housing **302** may be a plastic or other rigid or semi-rigid material that serves as a

housing for display assembly **301**. Various components, such as main circuit board **303**; mesh network communication interface **307**; top daughterboard **308**; button assembly **309**; radar assembly **310**; and microphone assembly **311** may be mounted on display housing **302**. Mesh network communication interface **307**; top daughterboard **308**; radar assembly **310**; and microphone assembly **311** may be connected to main circuit board **303**, using flat wire assemblies. Display housing may be attached with display assembly **301**, using an adhesive.

[0100] Mesh network communication interface **307** may include one or more antennas and may enable communication with a mesh network, such as a Thread-based mesh network. Wi-Fi assembly **315** may be located a distance from mesh network communication interface **307** to decrease the possibility of interference. Wi-Fi assembly **315** may enable communication with a Wi-Fi based network.

[0101] Radar assembly **310**, which can include radar subsystem **120** or radar subsystem **205**, may be positioned such that its RF emitter and RF receiver are away from the metallic plate of display assembly **301** and are located a significant distance from mesh network communication interface **307** and Wi-Fi assembly **315**. These three components may be arranged in approximately a triangle to increase the distance between the components and decrease interference. For instance, in device **300**, a distance of at least 74 mm between Wi-Fi assembly **315** and radar assembly **310** may be maintained. A distance of at least 98 mm between mesh network communication interface **307** and radar assembly **310** may be maintained. Additionally, distance between radar assembly **310** and speaker **318** may be desired to minimize the effect of vibrations on radar assembly **310** that may be generated by speaker **318**. For instance, for device **300**, a distance of at least 79 mm between radar assembly **310** and speaker **318** may be maintained. Additionally, distance between the microphones and radar assembly **310** may be desired to minimize any possible interference from the microphones on received radar signals. Top daughterboard **308** may include multiple microphones. For instance, at least 12 mm may be maintained between a closest microphone of top daughterboard **308** and radar assembly **310**.

[0102] Other components may also be present. A third microphone assembly may be present, microphone assembly **311**, which may be rear-facing. Microphone assembly **311** may function in concert with the microphones of top daughterboard **308** to isolate spoken commands from background noise. Power board **316** may convert power received from an AC power source to DC to power the components of device **300**. Power board **316** may be mounted within device **300** using power bracket assembly **317**. Rocker switch bracket **312**, rocker switch board **313**, and rocker switch button **314** may be collectively used to receive user input, such as up/down input. Such input may be used, for example, to adjust a volume of sound output through speaker **318**. As another user input, button assembly **309** may include a toggle button that a user can actuate. Such a user input may be used to activate and deactivate all microphones, such as for when the user desires privacy and/or does not want device **300** to respond to voice commands.

[0103] FIG. 4 illustrates an embodiment of a state machine **400** for determining when a person is sleeping. Based upon data output by radar processing module **112**, sleep state detection engine **114** may determine whether a person is sleeping using state machine **400**. It should be understood that in some embodiments, sleep state detection engine **114** is incorporated as part of the functionality of radar processing module **112** and does not exist as a separate module. State machine **400** may include five possible sleep states: entering bed state **401**; not in bed state **402**; motion in bed state **403**; no motion in bed state **405**; and exiting bed state **404**.

[0104] If no motion-indicative waveform data is present, this may be indicative that the user is not in bed. A user who is in bed can be expected to always be moving in at least small amounts due to their vital signs. Therefore, if zero movement is observed, the user may be judged to be in state **401**. Following state **401** being determined, the next possible state that may be determined is state **402**. In state **402**, the monitored user is entering bed. Significant user motion may be sensed, such as according to Table 2. This may be indicative of a user entering bed and may cause the state to

transition from state **401** to state **402**.

[0105] From state **402**, motion may continue to be detected in bed, such as due to the user rolling around, getting positioned, moving pillows, sheets, and/or blankets, reading a book, etc. State **402** may transition to state **403** while such motion continues to be detected. Alternatively, if motion is detected, then zero motion is detected, this may be indicative that state **405** has been entered by the monitored user exiting bed. If this condition occurs, state **402** may transition to state **405**, then back to state **401**. Generally, state **404** may be interpreted as the user being asleep and state **403** may be interpreted as the user being awake. In some embodiments, more than a threshold amount of time (or some other form of determination that uses a form of threshold criterion at least partially based on time) in state **404** is necessary to classify the user as asleep and more than a threshold amount of time (or some other form of determination that uses a form of threshold criterion at least partially based on time) in state **403** is necessary to classify the user as awake. For instance, movement in bed of less than five seconds may be interpreted as the user moving while still asleep if the user was previously determined to be asleep. Therefore, if a user transitions to state **403** from state **404**, experiences some number of movement events, then returns to state **404** within less than a duration of time, the user may be identified as having experienced a “sleep arousal” in which the user's sleep is disturbed, but the user has not been awoken. Such sleep arousals may be tracked together with or separate data may be maintained from episodes where the user is judged to have fully awoken.

[0106] From state **403**, the monitored user may be determined to be exiting bed at state **405** and may become motionless at state **404**. To be “motionless” at state **404** refers to no large movements being performed by the monitored user, but the user continuing to perform small motions due to vital signs. In some embodiments, only when the monitored user's state is determined to be state **404** are vital signs treated as accurate and/or stored, recorded, or otherwise used to measure the user's vital signs. Data collected during state **403** and state **404** may be used to determine the monitored user's general sleep patterns (e.g., how much time tossing and turning, how much quality sleep, when deep sleep occurred, when REM sleep occurred, etc.). After a user enters state **404** for a predefined period of time, the user may be assumed to be asleep until the user exits state **404**. When a user initially transitions to state **404**, the user may be required to stay in state **404** for some amount of time, such as two to five minutes, to be considered asleep. If a user is in state **403** for at least a defined period of time, the user may be identified as awake. However, if the user enters state **403** from state **404** for less than the defined period of time, and returns to state **404**, the user may be identified as just moving within their sleep and has been continuously asleep.

[0107] FIG. 5 illustrates a diagram **500** of reflected radar chirps being received that were transmitted in a burst mode. Diagram **500** is representative of reflected, received radar chirps when radar subsystem **205** (or, more generally, radar subsystem **120**) is operating in burst mode. In burst mode, bursts **510** (which can also be referred to as frames) are received by radar subsystem **205**. A single burst includes some number of chirps. A reflected chirp is received for each chirp emitted by radar subsystem **205**. As illustrated, burst **510-1** can include five reflected chirps: chirp **511-1**, chirp **511-2**, chirp **511-3**, chirp **511-4**, and chirp **511-5**. In other embodiments, a burst includes greater or fewer numbers of chirps. For example, in some embodiments, a burst includes 3, 4, 10, 15, 20, or some other number of chirps. A burst may include any number of chirps between 2 and 100 chirps.

[0108] Within a burst, such as burst **510-1**, chirps may be transmitted, and thus reflected and received, about every 0.333 ms. Therefore, time **512** may be 0.333 ms. In other embodiments, time **512** is greater or smaller. For instance, time **512** may be between 0.01 ms and 5 ms. The burst period, that is, time **514**, which represents the amount of time between burst **510-1** beginning and burst **510-2** beginning may be 33.3 ms. In other embodiments, time **514** is larger or smaller, such as between 15 ms and 500 ms. Between each burst, such as between burst **510-1** and burst **510-2** a relatively larger amount of time can elapse than between adjacent chirps within a burst. For example, the amount of time, time **513-1**, between burst **510-1** and burst **510-2** (that is, the amount of time elapsing between chirp **511-5** and chirp **511-6** may be 26.7 ms. In other embodiments, time

513-1 is greater or smaller, such as any value between 1 ms and 200 ms. Regardless of the embodiment, time **513-1** larger than time **512**; that is, the time between adjacent chirps within a burst or frame is smaller than the time between bursts.

[0109] The timing between bursts **513** may be fixed; therefore, time **513-1**, time **513-2**, and time **513-4** may be the same. Similarly, the time between chirps within a burst can be constant. The radar subsystem can continuously operate in this mode without needing to change mode for vital detection.

[0110] FIG. **6** illustrates a diagram **600** of radar chirps being received as part of a burst mode radar data stream and converted to a virtual continuous mode radar data stream. As a reflected radar chirp is received by the radar subsystem, it may be mixed with the frequency currently being emitted, thus creating a mixed received radar chirp. The conversion of diagram **600** may be performed by virtual continuous chirp creator **240** based on the raw chirp waterfall output by the radar subsystem. As detailed in relation to FIG. **5**, the radar sensor may operate in burst mode and, thus, may receive reflected radar chirps in a burst pattern. The waveform data or raw chirp waterfall output by the radar subsystem operating in burst mode can be referred to as a burst mode radar data stream. This burst mode radar data stream is indicated in FIG. **6** by the graphical representations of bursts **510** and chirps **511**.

[0111] Conversions **610** are performed to convert each reflected burst in the raw chirp waterfall to a single, representative virtual continuous radar chirp **620**. Conversion **610-1** (represented by an arrow) converts reflected burst **510-1** to virtual continuous radar chirp **620-1**; conversion **610-2** converts burst **510-2** to virtual continuous chirp **620-2**; conversion **610-3** converts burst **510-3** to virtual continuous chirp **620-3**; conversion **610-4** converts burst **510-4** to virtual continuous chirp **620-4**, and so on.

[0112] To perform conversion **610-1**, each of chirps **511-1** through **511-5**, is sampled a number of times from the burst mode radar data stream. This sampling can occur at some number of chirp sampling points, such as chirp sampling point **605-1** through chirp sampling point **605-7**. (The arrows representing sampling points **605-3**, **605-4**, **605-5**, and **605-6** are not labelled for simplicity of FIG. **6**.) As an example, if five chirps are present in burst **510-1** and seven chirp sampling points are used, a total of 35 samples (7 samples for each chirp) may be sampled from burst **510-1**. The number of chirp sampling points used may vary by embodiment and may be greater or fewer than the seven chirp sampling points shown in FIG. **6**.

[0113] As part of conversion **610-1**, an averaging or combining process may be performed. Generally, each of the chirps of burst **510-1** (chirp **511-1** through chirp **511-5**) may be averaged together. To accomplish this averaging: the sample for each chirp of burst **510-1** taken at chirp sampling point **605-1** may be averaged together; the sample for each chirp of burst **510-1** taken at chirp sampling point **605-2** may be averaged together; the sample for each chirp of burst **510-1** taken at chirp sampling point **605-3** may be averaged together; the sample for each chirp of burst **510-1** taken at chirp sampling point **605-4** may be averaged together; the sample for each chirp of burst **510-1** taken at chirp sampling point **605-5** may be averaged together; the sample for each chirp of burst **510-1** taken at chirp sampling point **605-6** may be averaged together; and the sample for each chirp of burst **510-1** taken at chirp sampling point **605-7** may be averaged together. Stated more generally, each sample of a chirp is averaged with a corresponding sample of each other chirp of the burst. For example, the third sample of a chirp is averaged with the third samples of each other chirp of the burst.

[0114] For the illustrated embodiment, the seven averaged samples may then be used to construct a virtual continuous radar chirp **620-1**. For instance, the first averaged value from chirp sampling point **605-1** is used as the first sample **621-1** of virtual continuous radar chirp **620-1**; the second averaged value from chirp sampling point **605-2** is used as the second sample **621-2** of virtual continuous radar chirp **620-1**, and so on. Stated more generally, the averaged samples of burst **510-1** are concatenated to create virtual continuous radar chirp **620-1**.

[0115] Stated another way, sample-wise averaging is performed for each of burst **510**.

Mathematically, each chirp in a burst can be represented using the notation $c_{\text{sub},i,j}$, where i is the index for the sample of the chirp and j is the index for the chirp within the burst. Therefore, $c_{\text{sub},2,3}$ would be the second sample of the third chirp within a given burst. Equation 4 can be used to find the average values used to create the virtual continuous radar chirp:

$$V_k = \text{average}(c_{k,1}, c_{k,2}, c_{k,3}, \dots, c_{k,N}) \quad \text{Eq. 4}$$

[0116] In Equation 4, N represents the number of chirps within the burst and k represents the sample number. $V_{\text{sub},k}$ represents the averaged value corresponding to the k th sample. Equation 4 would be repeated k times to obtain all $V_{\text{sub},k}$ values that are used to construct the virtual continuous radar chirp.

[0117] The created virtual continuous radar chirps **620** may be spaced in time at equal intervals. For instance, time **630-1** may be 33.3 ms, which may match the burst period detailed in relation to FIG. 5. Times **630-2**, **630-3**, etc., can match time **630-1** such that the virtual continuous radar chirps are output periodically. More generally, since a single virtual continuous radar chirp is generated for each burst of bursts **510**, times **630** may be the same as the period of bursts **510**. By each virtual continuous radar chirp being equally spaced in time, the virtual continuous radar chirps may be more effective than the burst mode radar data stream to use for health monitoring. Virtual continuous radar chirps **620** may be output as a virtual continuous mode radar data stream to other components for processing. If such other components are implemented as software, the processing may be performed using the same processor(s) or processing system used to perform the functions of virtual continuous chirp creator **240**.

[0118] By chirps **511** of burst **510-1** being averaged together, virtual continuous radar chirp **620-1** can be higher resolution than any of individual chirps **511**. The reflected radar received by radar subsystem **120** (or **205**) may be converted to digital data using an analog to digital converter (ADC). The ADC may have a limited resolution, such as 8 bits. Therefore, all the values output by the ADC may be limited to a range of 0 to 256, which corresponds to eight binary bits. Dithering is a concept in signal processing that can result in trading signal fidelity for an increase in resolution. By averaging or otherwise combining multiple reflected noisy chirps, dithering can be exploited to obtain a resolution higher than output by the ADC used to convert the analog radar signals to the digital waveform data present in the digital burst mode radar data stream. The intuition is that a sample in a series of noisy chirps will dither around the true value slightly with added ADC noise. With multiple chirps being aggregated, measured values are captured in a statistically accurate way. Without noise, even with many chirps in burst, there can be no statistical advantage as each sample over the chirps will have the same value that can suffer from ADC quantization. The resulting higher-resolution signal with dithering has a higher fidelity in detecting weak signatures, such as human vital signs (e.g. breathing, heartbeats).

[0119] Various methods may be performed using the systems and arrangements detailed in relation to FIGS. 1-6. FIG. 7 illustrates an embodiment of a method **700** for monitoring for contactless human interactions and monitoring health using a single radar modulation mode. Method **700** can be performed using the devices and systems detailed in relation to FIGS. 1-3B.

[0120] At block **705**, radio waves are emitted by a radar subsystem or radar sensor. The radio waves emitted may be continuous-wave radar, such as FMCW, as detailed in relation to FIG. 2C. The radar sensor may operate in burst mode, such that radar chirps are emitted (and therefore received) in a pattern similar to FIG. 2C. The radio waves emitted may be emitted by RF emitter **206** of radar subsystem **205**, which may use one or more antennas to emit the radio waves. At block **710**, reflections of the radio waves may be received, such as by RF receiver **207** of radar subsystem **205**. The reflections received at block **810** may be reflected off of moving objects (e.g., a person having a heartbeat and breathing) and stationary objects. The pattern of received, reflected radio waves may approximately mirror the pattern in which the radio waves were emitted; therefore,

diagram **500** may approximately represent the pattern in which the bursts of chirps were transmitted and also bursts of reflected chirps were received.

[0121] At block **715**, a raw chirp waterfall, which can be referred to as a burst mode radar data stream, is created based on received reflected radio waves. The radar subsystem or sensor may use an on-board ADC to convert the received, reflected radar signals to the digital domain. In some embodiments, data received from different antennas of the radar subsystem is maintained separately. The digital burst mode radar data stream may be output by the radar subsystem to a processing system, such as a processing system that performs the functions of virtual continuous chirp creator **240** and/or human interaction engine **245**.

[0122] At block **720** the burst mode radar data stream may be analyzed to determine if any contactless human interaction is present, such as a gesture or a human presence. The burst mode radar data stream may be analyzed directly for this human interaction regardless of the state of health monitoring performed in blocks **725** and **730**. If a contactless human interaction is detected at block **720**, one or more actions may be taken at block **722** in response to the detection. For instance, a command may be executed or output to another device based on the detected gesture. If a human presence is detected, an action may be taken, such as illuminating electronic display **140** (and presenting information) or outputting audio, such as synthesized speech.

[0123] Independent of blocks **720** and **722**, method **700** can involve block **725** being performed. Therefore, block **725** may be performed while blocks **720** and/or **720** are being performed. At block **725**, the same burst mode radar data stream that was, is, or will be analyzed for a contactless human interaction at block **720** can be processed to create a virtual continuous chirp radar data stream. As detailed in relation to FIG. **6**, a conversion, which can involve an averaging process, may be performed to convert a burst of radar chirps to a virtual continuous radar chirp. Multiple virtual continuous chirps are assembled into a virtual continuous radar data stream that is output (as digital data) to one or more other components, which may be implemented using the same processing system that created the virtual continuous radar data stream or a separate processing system. By combining multiple chirps within a burst into a single virtual continuous mode chirp, the virtual continuous mode chirp can benefit from dithering, and thus have a higher resolution than individual chirps of a burst present in the burst mode radar data stream.

[0124] At block **730**, health monitoring, such as sleep tracking, vital sign monitoring, cough monitoring, or sleep disturbance attribution may be performed as detailed in relation to the functionality of radar processing module **210**. The health monitoring may function or may function more effectively based on a continuous radar data stream as opposed to a burst mode radar data stream. In other embodiments, some other form of monitoring or tracking can be performed based on the continuous radar data stream.

[0125] The methods, systems, and devices discussed above are examples. Various configurations may omit, substitute, or add various procedures or components as appropriate. For instance, in alternative configurations, the methods may be performed in an order different from that described, and/or various stages may be added, omitted, and/or combined. Also, features described with respect to certain configurations may be combined in various other configurations. Different aspects and elements of the configurations may be combined in a similar manner. Also, technology evolves and, thus, many of the elements are examples and do not limit the scope of the disclosure or claims.

[0126] Specific details are given in the description to provide a thorough understanding of example configurations (including implementations). However, configurations may be practiced without these specific details. For example, well-known circuits, processes, algorithms, structures, and techniques have been shown without unnecessary detail in order to avoid obscuring the configurations. This description provides example configurations only, and does not limit the scope, applicability, or configurations of the claims. Rather, the preceding description of the configurations will provide those skilled in the art with an enabling description for implementing

described techniques. Various changes may be made in the function and arrangement of elements without departing from the spirit or scope of the disclosure.

[0127] Also, configurations may be described as a process which is depicted as a flow diagram or block diagram. Although each may describe the operations as a sequential process, many of the operations can be performed in parallel or concurrently. In addition, the order of the operations may be rearranged. A process may have additional steps not included in the figure. Furthermore, examples of the methods may be implemented by hardware, software, firmware, middleware, microcode, hardware description languages, or any combination thereof. When implemented in software, firmware, middleware, or microcode, the program code or code segments to perform the necessary tasks may be stored in a non-transitory computer-readable medium such as a storage medium. Processors may perform the described tasks.

[0128] Having described several example configurations, various modifications, alternative constructions, and equivalents may be used without departing from the spirit of the disclosure. For example, the above elements may be components of a larger system, wherein other rules may take precedence over or otherwise modify the application of the invention. Also, a number of steps may be undertaken before, during, or after the above elements are considered.

Claims

1. A smart device, comprising: a housing that is configured for placement of the smart device in areas of user activity, user sleep, or both; a radar sensor, housed by the housing, configured to operate in a burst mode in which the radar sensor transmits a plurality of bursts of radar chirps, receives reflections of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps, and outputs a radar data stream based on the reflections of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps; and a processing system, housed by the housing, comprising one or more processors, that is in communication with the radar sensor, the processing system configured to: perform a first set of operations on the radar data stream to perform user activity recognition; and perform a second set of operations on the radar data stream to perform vital sign detection, wherein no radar transmission mode changes are required to perform the user activity recognition and the vital sign detection using the radar data stream.
2. The smart device of claim 1, wherein: a first amount of time elapsing between adjacent radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps is smaller than a second amount of time elapsing between adjacent bursts of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps.
3. The smart device of claim 1, wherein the user activity recognition is gesture detection.
4. The smart device of claim 1, wherein the second set of operations comprises instructions to convert the radar data stream to a virtual continuous mode radar data stream.
5. The smart device of claim 4, wherein the virtual continuous mode radar data stream comprises a plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time.
6. The smart device of claim 5, wherein the instructions to convert the radar data stream to the virtual continuous mode radar data stream comprises instructions that cause the processing system to: create a virtual reflection of a radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts, wherein the virtual reflection of the radar chirp is part of the plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time.
7. The smart device of claim 6, wherein the processing system being configured to create the virtual reflection of the radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of the burst of the plurality of bursts comprises the processing system being configured to perform an averaging process comprising: sampling a plurality of samples of each radar chirp of the multiple chirps of the burst; averaging each sample of the plurality of samples with corresponding samples from the other chirps of the multiple chirps of the burst to create a plurality of averaged samples; and assembling the averaged samples to create the virtual reflection of the radar chirp.
8. The smart device of claim 7, wherein the user activity recognition is performed while detection

of the vital sign detection is being performed.

9. The smart device of claim 1, wherein the radar sensor outputs RF having a frequency between 45 GHz and 80 GHz.

10. The smart device of claim 1, wherein the radar sensor outputs RF having a peak equivalent isotopically radiated power (EIRP) of less than 20 dBm.

11. A method for monitoring for contactless human interactions and monitoring health using a single radar modulation mode, the method comprising: emitting radar chirps, by a radar sensor operating in a burst mode, such that the radar sensor emits a plurality of bursts of radar chirps; and the radar sensor outputs a burst mode radar data stream that is based on reflections of the radar chirps of the plurality of bursts or radar chirps; receiving, by a processing system, the burst mode radar data stream from the radar sensor; performing, by the processing system, a first set of operations on the radar data stream to perform user activity recognition; and performing, by the processing system, a second set of operations on the radar data stream to perform vital sign detection, wherein no radar transmission mode changes are required to perform the user activity recognition and the vital sign detection using the radar data stream.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein a first amount of time elapsing between subsequent radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps is smaller than a second amount of time elapsing between subsequent bursts of the plurality of bursts of radar chirps.

13. The method of claim 11, wherein performing the second set of operations comprises converting, by the processing system, the burst mode radar data stream to a virtual continuous mode radar data stream.

14. The method of claim 13, wherein the virtual continuous mode radar data stream is comprised of a plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein converting the burst mode radar data stream to the virtual continuous mode radar data stream comprises: creating a virtual reflection of a radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of a burst of the plurality of bursts, wherein the virtual reflection of the radar chirp is part of the plurality of virtual reflections of radar chirps spaced equally in time.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein creating the virtual reflection of the radar chirp based on the multiple radar chirps of the burst of the plurality of bursts comprises: sampling a plurality of samples of each radar chirp of the multiple chirps of the burst; averaging each sample of the plurality of samples with corresponding samples from the other chirps of the multiple chirps of the burst to create a plurality of averaged samples; and assembling the averaged samples to create the virtual reflection of the radar chirp.

17. The method of claim 11, wherein the contactless human interaction is a gesture.

18. The method of claim 11, wherein the contactless human interaction is presence detection.

19. The method of claim 11, wherein the health monitoring comprises sleep monitoring of the user.

20. The method of claim 11, wherein emitting the radar chirps comprises output RF having a peak equivalent isotopically radiated power (EIRP) of less than 20 dBm.
